

MS 492 -IV

Course Title: Business Ethics & Responsible Leadership

Instructor: Dr. Ramachandran Veetikazhi

Credits (L T P C): 3 0 0 2

Proposed Dates and Times for Lectures:

First half of II Semester Slots L1, L2

Venue: 10/102

About the Course:

This course is intended to teach students the underlying principles of business ethics and responsible leadership. The students are taught about the qualities of a responsible leader, ethical dilemmas, unintentional unethical behaviour, and approaches to ethical decision-making. Through several easily understood case studies, students learn how the world's admired organizations have successfully earned public trust by behaving socially responsibly.

Methodology:

The course shall be delivered through lectures, case studies, videos, and group presentations.

Objectives:

The principal objective of the course is to familiarize the students with the characteristics of responsible leadership required to drive an ethical organization.

Outcomes:

Understand ethical dilemmas and how to navigate them

..[Learn how to avoid ethical sinkholes as a leader.

Recognize how implicit biases make one unintentionally unethical.

Comprehend how to emerge as a responsible leader, respected by stakeholders.

Schedule

Class 1: Foundations of business ethics - Understanding basic terms, the need for ethics in business, ethical decision-making process. The murder of Kitty Genovese.

Class 2: - Individual differences in ethical behaviour– Cognitive moral development, Heinz dilemma, locus of control, Machiavellianism, moral disengagement.

Class 3: Individual and common ethical issues– Discrimination, sexual harassment, conflict of interest, customer trust, use of corporate resources, whistleblowing. The case of Jeffrey Wigand.

Class 4: Approaches to ethical reasoning - The trolley problem, consequentialism, deontological ethics, virtue ethics, care ethics. Ethics in Mahabharata.

Class 5: Unconscious biases and ethical blindness - Bounded rationality, bounded ethicality,

ethical fading, moral decoupling, biases. The Challenger disaster.

Class 6: Ethical culture in organizations – Organizational culture and climate, normalization of corruption in organization, formal and informal cultural systems. The Enron scandal.

Class 7: Ethics and compliance – Corporate ethics committee, ethics and compliance officers, ethical infrastructure. (Group Presentations 1 and 2)

Class 8: Ethics and communication – Mission and value statements, ethics codes, top management commitment, reward and punishment. (Group Presentations 3 and 4)

Class 9: Managing ethical conduct – Multiple ethical selves, group norms, roles, Stanford prison experiment, excessive obedience to authority, Milgram experiment, diffused responsibility, stressed-out employees. (Group Presentations 5 and 6)

Class 10: Ethical problems of managers : Hiring and work assignments, performance evaluation, discipline, terminations. The Wells Fargo scandal. (Group Presentations 7 and 8)

Class 11: Responsible leadership– The Hitler problem, the dark leadership triad, and the four quadrants of responsible leadership.

Class 12: Business ethics and society – Corporate social responsibility, economic, legal, ethical and philanthropic responsibilities, organizational reputation, the nine principles of BRSR, greenwashing.

Class 13: Ethical problems for organizations – Ethics and stakeholder demands, product safety, pricing issues, environmental issues.

Class 14: Review of learnings– Reflections and conclusion

Evaluation

The evaluation shall be based on two assignments (60 marks) and an examination (40 marks).

Assignment 1: “My reflections on business ethics and responsible leadership”. Prepare a diary based on class teaching and personal observations/experiences

Assignment 2: Group presentations. 10-minute presentation, 5-minute Q&A. Maximum 10 slides (Brief of the case, ethical issues involved, lessons learnt by you on ethics and responsible leadership). Maximum marks

Textbooks

1. Managing business ethics: Straight Talk about how to do it right, 8th ed. by Trevino, Linda K. and Nelson, Katherine A.
2. Business ethics: ethical decision making and cases, 12th ed. by Ferrell, O. C., Fraedrich, John and Ferrell, Linda
3. Ethics and the conduct of business. Boatright, J.R., Jeffery, D.S., and Patra, B.P. (2017). Eighth Edition. Pearson.
